

James Praise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Demand generation and growth operator with 7+ years building B2B lead engines from a standing start, usually as the first person whose job is the funnel. I plan from the target back: meetings needed, then stage volumes, then budget, and I report cost per stage rather than activity. I run paid search and paid social myself, brief creative teams instead of waiting on them, and run my marketing operation on a Claude Code system I built. My work has contributed to \$10M+ in qualified pipeline. More at jameppraise.xyz/work/shape.

Selected Achievements:

- Took a B2B technology and training provider through a full funnel as Chief Revenue Officer at Cecure Intelligence Limited: **1,646 MQLs, 406 SQLs and 629 demos booked**, with paid campaigns at **2-3x ROAS** on \$1.5K-\$15K monthly budgets.
- Built Bujeti's (YC W23) growth function from zero: **1,331 MQLs in 6 months, a 500% increase in new B2B customers**, and **200+ MQLs from events and partnerships**.
- Lifted **MQL-to-SQL conversion 28%** and **enterprise meeting booking rates 31%** at FunnelEnvy with a HubSpot-based measurement stack and an account-based playbook.
- Launched a lead scoring system and nurture programs at Bento Africa that increased **SQL volume 50%** and **sales conversions 25%**.
- Built a paid-ads operating system across 8 platforms, published as the Paid Acquisition Playbook, that reconciles ad-platform conversions against real backend sales.

KEY SKILLS

Demand Generation: Full-Funnel Planning, Reverse Funnel & Budget Modelling, Cost per Stage Reporting, Paid Search, Paid Social, Retargeting, Webinars, Events, Account-Based Marketing, Lead Scoring, Nurture Design

Conversion & Handoff: Landing Page & Form Optimisation, Demo Booking Flows, Lead Routing & SLAs, MQL/SQL Definitions with Sales, Experimentation Frameworks

Tools: HubSpot, LinkedIn Campaign Manager, Google Ads, Meta Ads, GA4, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, Lightdash, Clay, Claude Code, n8n

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Growth & GTM Consultant | Marketing In Action | April 2024 – Present

Marketing In Action (GTM agency for SaaS, B2B and product-led companies)

- Run paid acquisition for Marketing In Action's own offers and client accounts on a self-built operating system: offer, creative, landing pages and tracking (GTM, GA4, Meta Conversions API, server-side tagging).
- Built a self-hosted webinar funnel (registration, live and replay rooms, checkout) that produced 193 registrations in its first 5 days of paid traffic, with pixel and backend counts matching.
- Published the Paid Acquisition Playbook: an 11-stage operating loop with checklists and templates for 8 ad platforms.

Growth, GTM & Demand Generation Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – April 2026

FunnelEnvy (B2B growth marketing service provider)

- Designed a quarterly demand gen roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid, delivering a 40% quarter-on-quarter increase in qualified enterprise leads.
- Built a cross-brand measurement stack in HubSpot, GA4, Looker Studio and Lightdash, improving reporting speed by 50% and MQL-to-SQL conversion by 28%.
- Built an account-based playbook with Clay, ExactBuyer and Instantly that lifted enterprise meeting booking rates by 31%.
- Revamped the homepage for a 24% increase in demo request click-through, and planned and hosted the company's first webinar.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – April 2026

Reform (SaaS, MarTech, lead conversion forms)

- Built integration and competitor pages that brought 19% more decision-stage leads, and lifted trial activation 34%.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti (YC W23) | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024

Bujeti (SaaS, FinTech, spend and expense management)

- Built the growth function from zero for a company relying on outbound, generating 1,331 MQLs in 6 months and a 500% increase in new B2B customers.
- Ran events and partnerships as a second lead source (200+ MQLs) and improved landing page conversion by 20%.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023

Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Africa)

- Owned the funnel from campaign to closed deal across five markets: 1,646 MQLs, 406 SQLs, 629 demos booked, \$326K in sales velocity and \$3.4M in open deal value.

- Ran paid acquisition at 2-3x ROAS on \$1.5K-\$15K monthly budgets, alongside events and cloud partnerships with AWS, Google and Microsoft.

Growth & Product Marketing Manager | Bento Africa | Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

Bento (SaaS, payroll and HR, four African markets)

- Designed a lead scoring system and nurture programs that increased SQL volume 50% and sales conversions 25%.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022

B2B, SaaS, ecommerce, agencies and service businesses

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0
- Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- Outbound Automation & AI GTM Engineering Certification | Clay (2025)
- BSc. Biochemistry | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0
- Certifications: HubSpot (SEO, SEM, Content Marketing), Google (Digital Analytics, Display Ads)